# App Development with Google AI & IDX

A streamlined guide for smart amateurs to build professional web apps using Google's latest "No-Install" tools.

# The "No-Install" Strategy

## Old Way

Downloading "Node.js", installing "VS Code", configuring "Git", fighting with "Terminal" errors, and managing local servers.

## The IDX Way

We use **Project IDX**. It's a full professional code editor that runs entirely in your browser. No downloads. No setup. It just works.

# Your 3-Step Toolkit

## 1. Gemini

**The Architect.**
Writes the actual code and database structure for you.

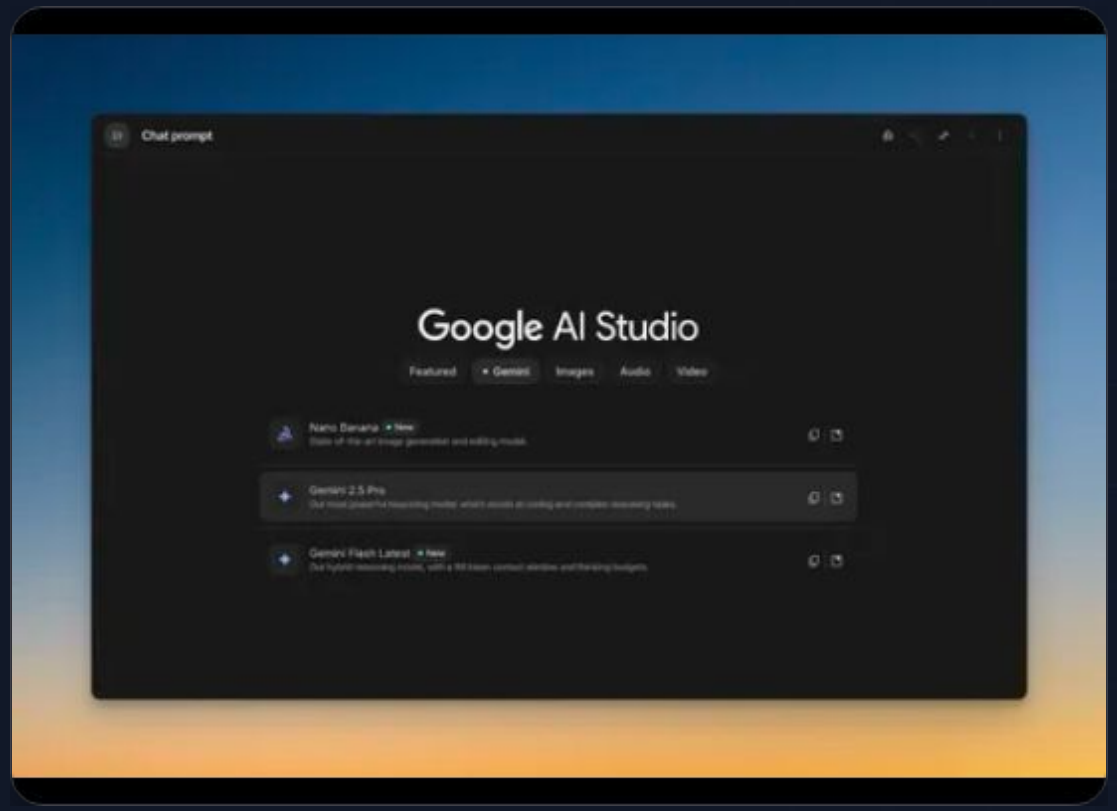
## 2. Project IDX

**The Workbench.**
Runs the code in the cloud so you can see your app live.

## 3. Firebase

**The Host.**
Stores your data and keeps your website online 24/7.

# Step 1: The Blueprint




## Prompting the Architect

Go to **aistudio.google.com**. This is where you tell Gemini what to build.

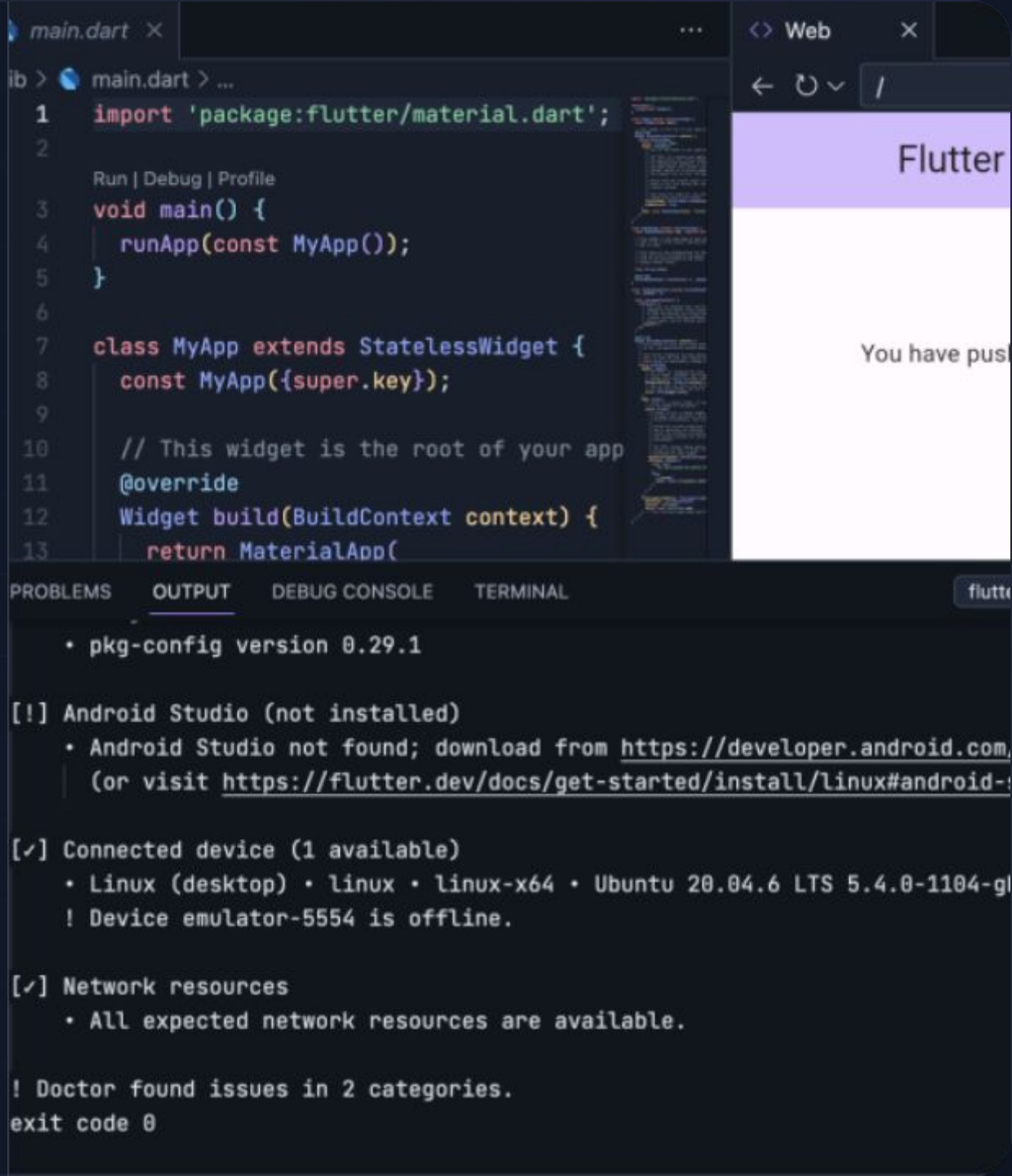
**Copy this prompt:**

> "Act as an expert React developer. I need a single-page 'Leaderboard App' that reads a list of creators from a JSON file. Display Rank, Name, and Score in a dark-mode table. Use Tailwind CSS for styling."

# Step 2: The Workspace

Go to **idx.google.com** and sign in.

- Click **"Create a workspace"**.
- Select the **"React Application"** template.
- Name it "agency-leaderboard".
- Wait 60 seconds. You will see a full code editor appear in your browser window.

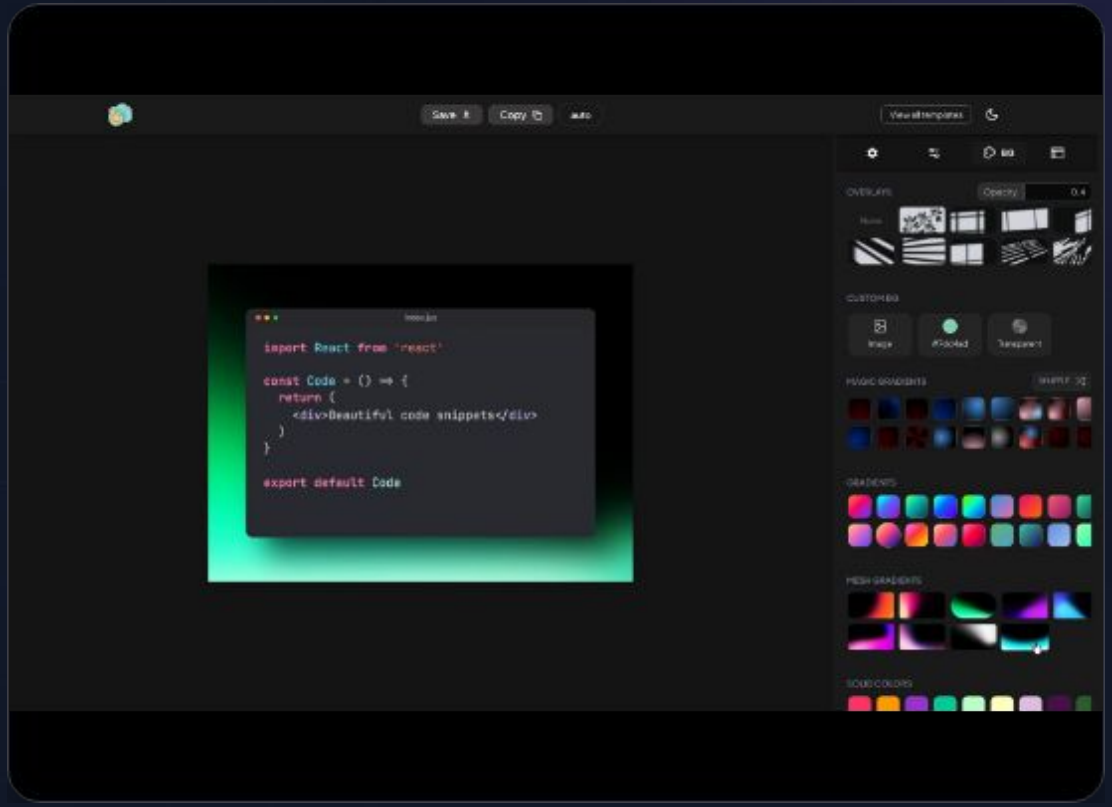


# Step 3: Generating Code

## Let Gemini Write It

Back in AI Studio, hit "Run". Gemini will generate the full code for a file called `App.js`

It will also generate the CSS styles. You don't need to understand every line, you just need to identify the **"Copy Code"** button at the top right of the code block.



# Step 4: Assembly

## Paste & Play

Switch back to your **Project IDX** tab.

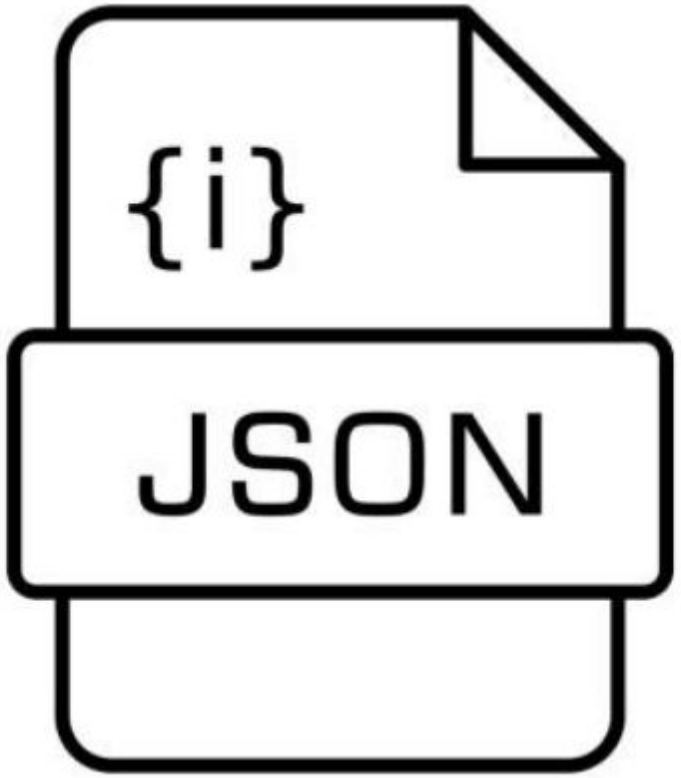
1. On the left file list, find `src/App.jsx`
2. Delete **everything** in that file.
3. **Paste** the code Gemini gave you.
4. Look at the "Preview" window on the right. Your app should instantly update!

# Step 5: The Database

Instead of a complex database, we will use a simple file for now.

1. In IDX, right-click the `src` folder and select **"New File"**.
2. Name it `creators.json`
3. Paste your creator data here in this format:

```
[
{"name": "Creator A", "score": 5000},
{"name": "Creator B", "score": 3200}
]
```



# Step 6: Go Live

To publish your site, use the "Terminal" at the bottom of Project IDX.

1

### Install Tools

```
npm install -g firebase-tools
```

2

### Login

```
firebase login
```

3

### Initialize

```
firebase init hosting
```

4

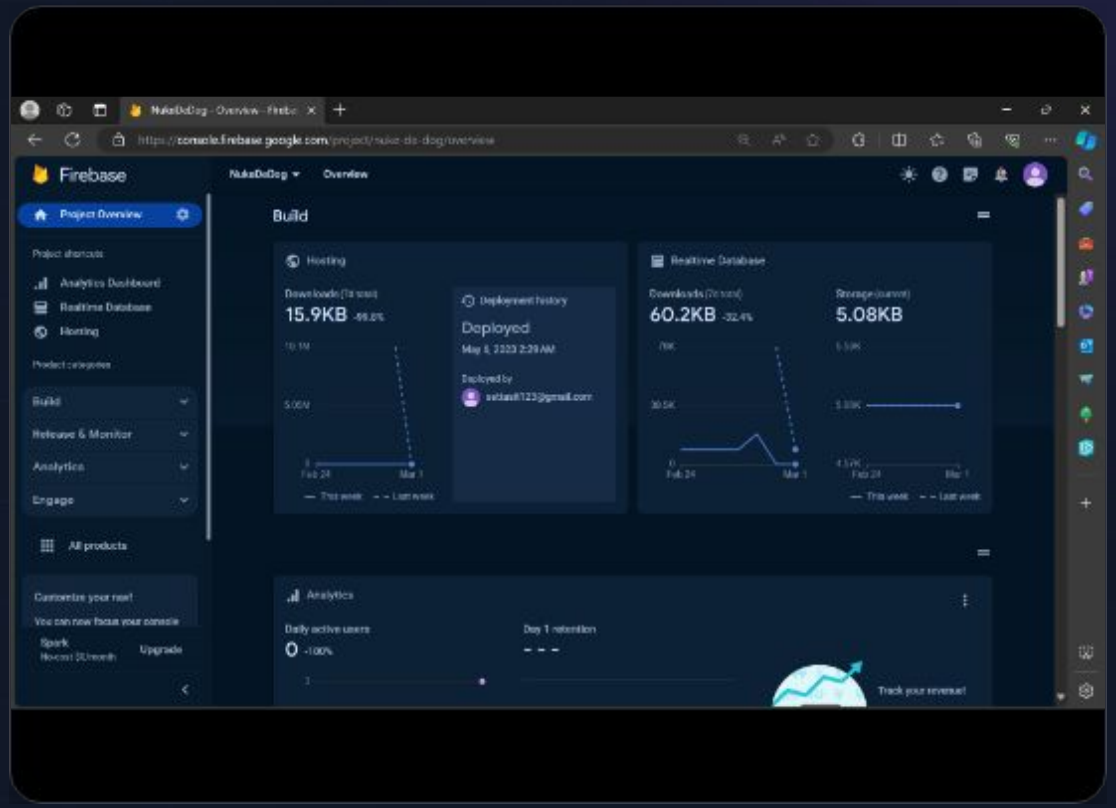
### Deploy

```
firebase deploy
```

# Daily Update Routine

Since this is a "Static" app (simplest version), updating the leaderboard is easy:

- Open **Project IDX** in your browser.
- Open `src/creators.json`
- Paste the new scores from your TikTok export.
- Run `firebase deploy`



# Pre-Flight Checklist

- **Data Check:** Ensure your JSON file has no missing commas or brackets.
- **Mobile Test:** Resize the IDX preview window to make sure it looks good on phone size.
- **Dark Mode:** Verify the text is readable against the dark background.
- **Public Link:** Test the "Hosting URL" Firebase gives you on your actual phone.

# Essential Resources

| Tool Name | Purpose | Website URL |
| --- | --- | --- |
| **Google AI Studio** | Generating the Code | `aistudio.google.com` |
| **Project IDX** | Code Editor (Workspace) | `idx.google.com` |
| **Firebase Console** | Hosting & Management | `console.firebase.google.com` |
| **React Documentation** | Reference (Optional) | `react.dev` |

# Image Sources

https://storage.googleapis.com/gweb-uniblog-publish-prod/images/welcome.width-500.format-webp.webp

Source: blog.google

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https://cdn.thenewstack.io/media/2023/11/67132d4d-idx_feature-1024x616.png

Source: thenewstack.io

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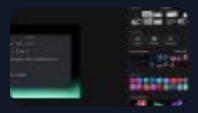

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Source: www.reddit.com

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https://png.pngtree.com/thumb_back/fw800/background/20251205/pngtree-close-up-of-a-programmer-s-hands-typing-code-on-backlit-image_20740687.webp

Source: pngtree.com

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Source: www.istockphoto.com

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Source: stackoverflow.com